[LIT-FLK-016] Chikhangai Kala Kashung wui Ngatara

Translation: The Race Between the Mountain Snail and the Fleet Barking Deer

Work Type: FOLK_TALE | Creator: Tangkhul Storytellers & TLS Element | Year: 1981
Village: Hunphun | Dialect: Standard Tangkhul | Book ID: BK-TLS-015
Publisher / Source: Tangkhul Literature Society, Manipur
Clearance: Community Authorized | Permission: community_authorized | Status: verified

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Themes: Humility and quiet diligence overcoming boastful arrogance (*Ning-kacham vs. Ning-ngasang*), Kinship solidarity and collective cooperation

Structure & Meter: Didactic animal fable structured in rhythmic prose stanzas suitable fo

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Critical Overview: A canonical fable compiled in early Tangkhul elementary school readers. It teaches communal mutual assistance and punctures the

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Indigenous Tangkhul Literary Text / Stanzas:

Hunphun ram kaphung-ngakui eili chikhangai akhana kashung kachamnao akha
'Kashung-nao, na-wui khui-kapam mathikha, Shirui kaphung mathakashung ka
Kashungna ningkacham eina horkashung: 'Chikhangai, nawui phakaphap hi ka
Chitharan chikhangaina ningtheikhamang eina thak-thak phaphorlaga, 'Kash
Kha kashung kachamnaona kaphung wui khur-kashak serli shara-ngara kachip
Chikhangaina 'Kashung!' da horkashung kachiva-li, akhan-akhang lungkuili

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English Translation & Literary Rendering:

High on the Hunphun hills, a proud barking deer encountered a humble sna
Boasting loudly, the deer jeered: 'Little snail, sluggish and frail, rac
With quiet modesty the snail responded: 'Swift deer, speed without wisdo
Leaping forward with lightning bounds, the deer ran ahead, then mocked t
Yet the resourceful snail had stationed his kin along every winding moun
Whenever the barking deer cried out 'Where are you, snail?', a snail's v

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Key Poetic & Literary Vocabulary Terms:

* Chikhangai : Barking deer (Muntiacus muntjak), nimble inhabitan
* Kashung : Mountain forest snail, symbol of patient endurance
* Ngatara : Formal competition, foot-race, or athletic trial